



Centre for Air Power Studies: We are congratulating ourselves that nothing has happened in last 11 months. Let's reverse this. Nothing has happened as Pakistan is pre-occupied with its troubles on its western border. In the wake of 9/11, infiltration into J&K has virtually been reduced to a trickle, from 13 to less than one a day. Since Chidambaram took over as home minister, preparedness levels have been heightened but we have a long way to go. If there is an aerial attack, which has been feared and talked about, we are not prepared at all on the southern side which is very vulnerable as there are no radars to detect an aerial intrusion. Unless we get a homeland security kind of a template to prevent terror attacks, nothing much can be done. There has been a great deal of improvement on the intelligence side but I am not sure whether there has been an improvement in assessments. Situational awareness in managing terror now and in the next 10 or 15 years is crucial for any mechanism that would come in. I think it was a statesman-like act in not exercising the military option post-26/11. We have seen the rich dividends that philosophy has paid.

Yes, we have precision attack capabilities and have strengthened it competently and can deliver punishment precisely, but we also need to factor into our calculus that Pakistan is not going to let that attack or series of attacks go uncontested. Are we prepared to get into a limited war? I would much rather go the Chinese way. After the war with Vietnam, they tucked their tail between the legs and ran back to Beijing because they wanted to develop. We must follow the same strategy and keep in mind that strategic importance of India is its 9 per cent growth rate in the next 20 years.

Kiran Bedi, Former DG, Bureau of Police Research and Development: We have more than a million policemen. I don't know whether any assessment has been made on their training, welfare or personnel policy. We invest nothing and have no objec-

BRAHMA CHELLANEY



“ We are better prepared, though not institutionally but at the level of governmental response.

Chidambaram has put everybody under pressure. For the first time, there is coordination at the senior-most level.

Naxalism is the biggest threat to India's security, but there was no action. Now there's an effort, if not a strategy, to deal with Naxal violence.

We have adopted a policy of throwing a dossier at Pakistan to keep them on the defensive.

If Pakistan doesn't act against the masterminds of 26/11, there will be no normalisation of relations with India. ”

AJIT KUMAR DOVAL

“ Chidambaram has been able to put his house in order and made optimal use of existing capacity.

Threat level has gone down because India has played its card in sustaining pressure and not letting it be put on the backburner.



Today, intelligence agencies are performing more effectively than before.

Pakistan has come to some sort of an assessment that any covert action in India may probably incur an unacceptable cost.

Institutional changes have not come up in a big way, except in setting up an investigation body. ”